

TEAM CRACKERS



ŠUNYS ASISTENTAI
(ENG. ASSISTANCE DOGS)

THE PROPOSAL

TITLE

FROM PAWS TO PROGRESS

DESCRIPTION

SOLUTION 1: DONATION BOXES IN SHOPS

We will partner with local shops, supermarkets, and pet stores to place branded donation boxes at their counters. These boxes will be attractively designed with clear messaging so that customers understand they are contributing to the cause of assistance dogs and disability inclusion. This requires minimal investment, and since footfall in these shops is already high, it ensures steady visibility and a reliable flow of small donations.

SOLUTION 2: EVENTS & CAMPAIGNS (DOG FAIR)

We will organize dog fairs and awareness events where people can participate in fun games and activities with their pets. Entry will be free to encourage large participation, but we will charge small participation fees for games and activities. Local vendors, vets, and pet product stalls will be invited, ensuring both safety and engagement. Our NGO will also have its own awareness stall to educate the community about assistance dogs. These events create community involvement, attract sponsors, and generate revenue while building awareness.

SOLUTION 3: AWARENESS WORKSHOPS IN SCHOOLS & COLLEGES

To spread awareness among the youth, we will conduct interactive workshops in schools and colleges. These workshops will explain what assistance dogs are, why they are important, and how they contribute to disability inclusion. We will charge a nominal fee from institutions to cover costs. This not only generates income but also builds the next generation's understanding and acceptance of assistance dogs.

SOLUTION 4: WEBSITE COLLABORATION WITH TRAINING SCHOOLS

We will revamp our NGO's website to make it more engaging and collaborative. A key feature will be showcasing partner assistance dog training schools. By providing space on our website to promote their programs, we will charge them a nominal listing fee. This creates a win-win: schools get more visibility, and our NGO earns recurring revenue while positioning itself as the central hub for information on assistance dogs.

SOLUTION 5: MERCHANDISE & FUNDRAISING PRODUCTS

We will design and sell dog-themed merchandise such as mugs, bottles, keychains, T-shirts, and aesthetic posters. These products will appeal to pet lovers and youth who enjoy fun, trendy items. Sales will be both online (print-on-demand) and offline at our events. This solution spreads awareness every time someone uses or wears the product, while also raising funds for our mission.

SOLUTION 6: CORPORATE TRAINING & CERTIFICATION (LONG-TERM)

As we scale, we will launch a corporate inclusion training program. We will approach companies directly to conduct specialized workshops on disability inclusion where they learn about assistance dogs, workplace accessibility, and inclusion practices. After completing the training and passing a short assessment, companies will receive an “Assistance Dog Inclusive” certification, boosting their CSR credentials. For companies, this certification becomes a badge of social responsibility; for us, it becomes a premium, high-value service.

MAIN COSTS

- **Donation Box Installation:** 4000
- **Per Fest Organising:** 1850
- **Website Handling:** 2500
- **Initial Inventory Cost:** 4110
- **Certifications:** 7300

FUND DRIVERS

- Earned Income (Donations,workshops,merchandise,courses,website,etc)
- National Donations and Fund raising programmes
- EU Programmes (Erasmus+)
- Corporate Sponserhips/CSR
- Microloans

MISSION ALIGNMENT

SOLUTION 1: DONATION BOXES IN SHOPS

Mission link: Spreads awareness to thousands of people daily through branded boxes, making the cause visible in public spaces.

Contribution: Provides steady grassroots funding while also sensitizing everyday shoppers to the role of assistance dogs in disability inclusion

SOLUTION 2: EVENTS & DOG FAIR

Mission link: Creates community-level engagement people bring pets, interact with assistance dog campaigns, and learn about disability inclusion in a fun, safe environment.

Contribution: Strengthens public understanding and empathy toward persons with disabilities; doubles as a fundraising + awareness event that positions the NGO at the center of inclusion conversations.

SOLUTION 3: AWARENESS WORKSHOPS IN SCHOOLS & COLLEGES

Mission link: Directly fulfills the NGO's educational and advocacy goal by shaping young minds to see assistance dogs as partners in independence, not as pets or dangers.

Contribution: Long-term cultural change so reduces stigma, builds future allies, and ensures youth-led awareness.

SOLUTION 4: WEBSITE COLLABORATION WITH TRAINING SCHOOLS

Mission link: Builds an information hub where people can access credible resources about assistance dogs and inclusion

MISSION ALIGNMENT

Contribution: Strengthens networking and collaboration across the assistance-dog ecosystem. The listing model not only sustains the NGO financially but also connects beneficiaries to real services, fulfilling a practical advocacy role.

SOLUTION 5: MERCHANDISE & FUNDRAISING PRODUCTS

Mission link: Every T-shirt, mug, or poster becomes a walking message of inclusion. People who buy and use them amplify awareness.

Contribution: Fundraising + visibility multiplier — merchandise spreads the NGO's values beyond events and into everyday life.

SOLUTION 6: CORPORATE DISABILITY INCLUSION TRAINING & CERTIFICATION

Mission link: Attacks stigma and misinformation at the workplace level, one of the most important spaces for inclusion.

Contribution: By training employees and certifying companies as "Disability Inclusive," the NGO creates systemic change — embedding inclusion into HR policies, corporate culture, and CSR strategies.

RISKS AND MITIGATIONS

SOLUTION 1

- **Low participation from stores:** stores and online platforms may be hesitant to clutter checkout processes or add donation prompts → emphasize CSR benefits for the company & expand using impact data.
- **Customer Annoyance / “Donation Fatigue”:** repeated donation asks during checkout may irritate customers → Keep messaging positive, prompts short and optional
- **Integration challenges with apps** → Pitch as CSR branding opportunity, provide ready-to-use plug-ins.

SOLUTION 2

- **Event logistics risk:** organizing fairs requires staff, planning, and upfront investment → start small, for big events secure sponsors before committing
- **Weather & Attendance Risks:** outdoor events can suffer from low turnout due to bad weather or poor promotion → cover the venues, partner with influencers and local media for promotion
- **Dependence on Big Sponsors:** if one or two sponsors withdraw, event funding could collapse → diversify sponsorship

SOLUTION 3

- **Affordability for Schools:** schools may lack funds to pay fees. → fund through municipal or corporate sponsorship

RISKS AND MITIGATIONS

SOLUTION 4

- **Limited Number of Schools:** in Lithuania, only a handful of assistance dog training schools exist → expand listings to include EU schools; make it an international directory over time.
- **Low traffic:** if the NGO's site doesn't attract enough traffic, training schools won't pay → integrate directory promotion with NGO's awareness campaigns.

SOLUTION 5

- **Inventory risk:** producing merchandise requires money upfront and creates risk of unsold stock → start with print-on-demand.
- **Distribution & Logistics:** selling and shipping items adds complexity → partner with e-commerce platforms (Etsy, Shopify, local online stores)
- **Limited Reach:** small NGO may not have enough audience to sell big volumes → promote products at events, integrate into sponsorships and awareness campaigns.

SOLUTION 6

- **Certification credibility:** certificate issued by a tiny NGO may be seen as low-value → first establish and make a big name of NGO and co-develop standards with trusted partners
- **Capacity constraints:** NGO currently has a limited staff, not enough to

IMPACT OF SOLUTIONS

- deliver, market and certify at scale → outsource trainers, scale gradually
- **Risk of “CSR washing”**: some companies may join just for PR, without real change → enforce standards and renew certifications annually

The proposed solutions collectively transform Šunys asistentai into a financially sustainable and socially impactful organization. By diversifying income streams through donation boxes, awareness events, workshops, merchandise, and corporate certifications, the NGO secures stable funding while reducing dependence on external grants. At the same time, each initiative directly advances the mission of disability inclusion whether by raising everyday awareness in public spaces, engaging communities through fairs, shaping young minds in schools, or embedding inclusion practices within companies. This dual impact not only strengthens the NGO's institutional credibility and long-term survival but also drives a broader cultural shift in Lithuania towards empathy, accessibility, and equal opportunities for persons with disabilities. In essence, these solutions ensure that Šunys asistentai is not just surviving, but actively leading the way in building an inclusive society.

SUSTAINABILITY AND SCALABILITY

Our solutions are designed with both short-term feasibility and long-term scalability in mind, ensuring the organization's resilience over the next five years. Donation boxes and awareness workshops provide immediate, low-cost entry points that can be scaled nationwide by partnering with retail chains and educational institutions. Events such as dog fairs and campaigns can start small and grow into flagship annual gatherings, attracting larger sponsors and greater public participation each year. The website collaboration model and merchandise sales offer scalable digital revenue streams, expanding organically as brand recognition grows. Most importantly, the corporate disability inclusion training and certification program ensures long-term sustainability by embedding the NGO's expertise into formal CSR frameworks creating a premium, repeatable service with high growth potential. Together, these initiatives balance quick wins with scalable growth levers, allowing Šunys asistentai to steadily increase revenue, expand impact, and remain financially independent while advancing disability inclusion consistently over the next five years.

COST BREAKDOWN

SOLUTION 1: DONATION BOXES

COSTS:

Box fabrication: $€30 \times 100 = €3,000$

Installation & permissions: $€20 \times 100 = €2,000$

Platform fees: 3–5% of raised funds

REVENUE:

Online donations: €80–150/year

Physical donations: $€0.025 \times 20 \text{ ppl} \times 100 \text{ boxes} \times 365 \approx €18,250/\text{year}$

Net: ~€18,000/year (after platform fees)

SOLUTION 6: CORPORATE CERTIFICATION

Framework: €2,000

Legal: €500

Branding: €300

Audit & assessment: €2,000

Marketing: €1,500

Training: €1,000

REVENUE:

Fee charged: €1,000/company

Assumption: 20 companies/year = €20,000/year

Net (Year 1): $\approx +€12,700$

Net (scalable): Grows with # of companies

SOLUTION 2: EVENTS & DOG FAIR

COSTS:

Venue & permits: €100

Logistics & setup: €1000

Health & safety: €500

Activities: €100

Public Liability Insurance = €150

REVENUE:

Vendor fees: $€150 \times 10 \text{ vendors} = €1,500$

Participation fees: $5 \text{ games} \times €5 \times 8 \text{ participants} = €200$

Awareness booth donations $\approx €100$

Total Revenue: $\approx €1,800$

Net: $\sim -€50/\text{event}$

SOLUTION 4: WEBSITE COLLABORATION

COSTS:

Upgrade/module: €2,000

Legal fees: €500

REVENUE:

Listing fee: $€200 \times \text{no. of schools/year}$

Matching fee: $€50 \times \text{no. of matches/year}$

SOLUTION 3: AWARENESS WORKSHOPS

REVENUE: €500/WORKSHOP

Assumption: 10 workshops/year

Annual Net: $\approx €5,000$

SOLUTION 5: MERCHANDISE

Design: €400

T-shirts: $€7 \times 100 = €700$

Mugs: $€4 \times 100 = €400$

Tote bags: $€4 \times 100 = €400$

Calendars: $€3 \times 100 = €300$

Posters: $€0.2 \times 50 = €10$

Website changes: €2,000

REVENUE:

T-shirts: $€18 \times 100 = €1,800$

Mugs: $€10 \times 100 = €1,000$

Tote bags: $€7 \times 100 = €700$

Calendars: $€8 \times 100 = €800$

Posters: $€4 \times 50 = €200$

Total Revenue: €4,500

FINANCIAL MODEL

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3	YEAR 4	YEAR 5
NET CASH INFLOW	27900	35690	43150	44065	54665
NET CASH OUTFLOW	15710	17674	30720	25325.8	27325.8
ENDING CASH BALANCE	12190	18016	12430	18738.3	27339.3

REVENUE SOURCES

- 1) Earned income — workshops / corporate training / events / merchandise / donations
- 2) National donation & fundraising platforms
- 3) EU programme grants

Erasmus+ (education & digital learning projects): Erasmus+ funds digital education, training & partnerships — ideal to build a micro-course platform and content for employers/schools.

Good fit for the online education + certification strand

- 4) Corporate sponsorships / CSR (local + international)
- 5) Micro-loans

SUPPORTING MATERIALS

SOLUTION	KEY ASSUMPTIONS	NOTES
1. DONATION BOXES	€20 INSTALLATION PER BOX; 100 BOXES INSTALLED; 20 PEOPLE/DAY DONATING €0.025 EACH; ONLINE DONATIONS €80–150/YEAR; PLATFORM FEE 3–5%.	CONSERVATIVE, SCALABLE WITH MORE BOXES.
2. EVENTS & DOG FAIR	10 VENDORS (€150 EACH); 5 GAMES WITH 8 PARTICIPANTS (€5 EACH PARTICIPATING FEE); AWARENESS BOOTH $\approx$ €100(VARIES)	4-8 EVENTS/YEAR.
3. AWARENESS WORKSHOPS	€500 CHARGED PER WORKSHOP; $\sim$ 10 WORKSHOPS/YEAR; MINIMAL COSTS (HOST PROVIDES VENUE).	COVERS TRAINER & MATERIAL EXPENSES.
4. WEBSITE COLLABORATIONS	UPGRADE + LEGAL = €2,500 (YEAR 1); €200/YEAR EACH SCHOOL; €50 EACH CLIENT-DOG MATCHES	RECURRING REVENUE AFTER YEAR 1.
5. MERCHANDISE	DESIGN €400; SHOP MODULE €2,000; BATCH OF 100 T-SHIRTS (€7), 100 MUGS (€4), 100 TOTE BAGS (€4), 100 CALENDARS (€3), 50 POSTERS (€0.2). SELLING PRICE: T-SHIRT €18, MUG €10, TOTE €7, CALENDAR €8, POSTER €4.	ASSUMES FULL BATCH SELLS EACH YEAR.
6. CORPORATE CERTIFICATION	SETUP €7,300 (FRAMEWORK, LEGAL, BRANDING, AUDIT, MARKETING, TRAINING); FEE = €1,000/COMPANY; 20 COMPANIES/YEAR ADOPT CERTIFICATION.	HIGH-VALUE CSR SERVICE, SCALABLE.

SUPPORTING MATERIALS

BENCHMARKING AND REAL WORLD SUCCESS

 £4M raised annually through 20,000 donation boxes	 Dog walks/fairs attract sponsors & donors
  Significant funds raised through branded merchandise sales	 Run workshops for companies as part of CSR initiatives



STRATEGY SOLUTION MATRIX